ZZ-P-001235A(GSA-FSS)
January 13, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. ZZ-P-001235
July 3, 1968

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PILLOW, BED (FLAKED URETHANE)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the requirements for a bed pillow with a flaked urethane foam filling.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378 - Plastic Film (Polyethylene Thin Gage).
V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil agencies).
Fed. Test Method No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams and Stitchings.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Prcedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7210

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Laws and Regulations:

16 CFR 303 - Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof).

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza., Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. At the option of the contractor, the material for the pillow cover shall be as specified in 3.1.1 or 3.1.1.1.

3.1.1 Cotton sateen. The pillow cover shall be fabricated from white, 100 percent cotton sateen. The flame resistance of the material shall be such that the maximum average length of char or destroyed material shall not exceed 5-1/2 inches when tested as specified in table II and the material shall not continue flaming for more than two seconds after the flame is removed from the specimen. The cloth shall be pre-shrunk and the residual shrinkage shall not exceed 1.5 percent in either the direction of the warp or the filling. After sizing and finishing, the nonfibrous material shall not exceed 5 percent, the ounces per square yard shall be a minimum of 6.2, and the minimum breaking strength shall be 55 pounds in the warp and 55 pounds in the filling direction. The nonfibrous material and breaking strength may be tested before the fabric has been treated with a fire resistant finish.

3.1.1.1 Twill. The pillow cover shall be fabricated from white, all cotton twill or a blend of 65 percent polyester and 35 percent cotton in a twill weave. After complete sizing and finishing, the ounces per square yard and breaking strength of the fabric shall meet the physical requirements specified in table I when tested as specified in table II. The flame resistance of the material shall be such that the maximum average length of char or destroyed material shall not exceed the requirements specified in table I when tested as specified in table II and the material shall not continue flaming for more than two seconds after the test flame is removed from the specimen. The material shall be pre-shrunk and residual shrinkage shall not exceed 1 percent in either the direction of the warp or filling. The total sizing, finishing and other nonfibrous material shall not exceed 5 percent.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Fabric	Ounces per sq. yd.	Breaking strength pounds - minimum Warp	Filling	Maximum length of char or destroyed material (inches)
Twill, all cotton or a blend of 65% polyester and 35% cotton	5	170	70	5-1/2

3.1.2 Shredded urethane filling. The material for the filling shall be made from all white foam urethane which is new (not used after manufacture) and has been shredded. The individual shredded pieces shall be predominately approximately 1/2 inch in diameter. Filling pieces smaller and greater than 1/2 inch may be included; however, larger pieces shall not exceed 2-1/4 inches in the longest dimension.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.3 Thread. The sewing thread used in the fabrication of the pillow cover shall be ticket number 50, 3-ply, white, Type I, IA2, conforming to V-T-276 or comparable thread of sufficient strength to insure fast seams and closing of the finished item.

3.2 Weight. The pillow shall be rectangular in shape and shall weigh 2-1/4 pounds. A plus or minus tolerance of 1/2 pound will be permitted.

3.3 Size of cover. The finished overall size of the cover, when flat and before filling with the urethane specified in 3.1.2, shall measure 20 inches wide by 26 inches long. A plus or minus tolerance of 1/2 inch will be permitted in both length and width.

3.4 Construction. At the option of the contractor the method of construction shall be either Option A, as specified in para. 3.4.1 or Option B, as specified in para. 3.4.2.

3.4.1 Option A. The cover shall be fabricated from two rectangular pieces of the fabric specified in 3.1.1. The sides and ends shall be neatly and securely sewn on the inside leaving an opening at one end to provide for insertion of the urethane filling specified in 3.1.2, after turning the cover to the right side. The sides and ends shall be sewn on the inside using stitch type 301 or 401 and seam type SSa-1, with stitching not less than 1/4 inch from the edges of the material. On final closure, the end opening shall be turned under sufficiently and securely stitched and seamed. All ends of stitching shall be securely backtacked a minimum of 1/4 inch when not caught securely in another seam or row of stitching.

3.4.2 Option B. The cover shall be fabricated from one rectangular piece of the fabric specified in 3.1.1. The sides and ends, as applicable, shall be neatly and securely sewn on the inside leaving an opening at an end to provide for insertion of the urethane filling specified in 3.1.2, after cover is turned to the right side. Sides and ends, as applicable, shall be sewn on the inside using stitch type 301 or 401 and seam type SSa-1, with stitching not less than 1/4 inch from the edges of the material. On final closure, the open end shall be turned under sufficiently and securely stitched and seamed. All ends of stitching shall be securely backtacked a minimum of 1/4 inch when not caught securely in another seam or row of stitching.

3.4.3 Stitches, seams and stitching. Stitches, seams and stitchings shall conform to the requirements of Fed. Std. No. 751. All seams shall be sewn with sufficient number of stitches to produce secure seams. Seams shall be straight and show no raw edges. Thread breaks shall be secured by stitching back of break not less than 1/2 inch. Labels required shall be securely stitched into the seam of the pillow.

3.5 Color. Unless otherwise specified, the color of the cover shall be white. (See 6.2)

3.6 Labels.

3.6.1 State labeling requirements. When required, each pillow shall have a label attached to conform with the legal requirements of the state in which it is manufactured. When allowed under state law, the information required under state regulations may be combined in the identification label.

3.6.2 Identification label. Unless otherwise specified, (6.2), each pillow shall have an identification label containing the following information printed in bold letters and numerals not less than 1/8 inch in height:

Nomencalture
Federal Stock Number
Contractor's name or trademark
Contract number and date.

3.6.3 Fiber identification. Each pillow shall be labeled, ticketed, or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.7 Workmanship. The finished pillow shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable quality levels.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Testing of components. Testing shall be performed on the components listed in table II, as applicable. The sample unit for testing shall be not less than 3 continuous yards of full width fabric. For fabric with a fire resistant finish, one yard must be an untreated sample. The sample size shall be as specified in table III. The lot size shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any specified requirements. The lot size shall be expressed in terms as shown in table II. The method of testing specified in Federal Test Method Std. No. 191, wherever applicable, and as listed in table II shall be followed.

TABLE II. Component testing

Component and lot size expressed in terms of:	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test Method
Cotton sateen (sq. yd.) or Twill, all cotton or a blend of 65% polyester and 35% cotton (sq. yd.)	Weight	3.1.1 & Table I	5041 1/
	Breaking strength	3.1.1 & Table I	5100 1/
	Shrinkage	3.1.1 & 3.1.1.1	5550 1/
	Nonfibrous material	3.1.1 & 3.1.1.1	2611 1/
	Flame-resistance	3.1.1 & Table I	5903 2/
Shredded urethane (lbs.)	Material identification	3.1.2	Commercial Standard 1/

1/ May be accepted based on contractor's certificate of compliance.
2/ The cloth shall pass this test after having been washed and dried 10 times according to the procedures described in Section 6.2 (III) and 6.3.2 B in the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists Test Method 124-1969.

TABLE III. Sample size

Lot size (units)	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

4.2.2 Intermediate inspection.

4.2.2.1 Dimensional examination. A dimensional examination shall be made on the finished cover. Any measurement deviating from the specified dimension by more than the tolerance shall be considered a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one cover. The sample unit shall be one cover. The AQL for this examination shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units. The sample size shall be selected in accordance with inspection level S-3 of MIL-STD-105.

4.2.3 Inspection of the end item.

4.2.3.1 Examination of the end item. Defects found during this examination shall be classified in accordance with the following list. The lot size shall be expressed in terms of one pillow. The unit of product shall be expressed in the same terms as the lot size. The applicable inspection level for the pillow shall be level I and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 major defects per hundred units and 10.0 total (major and minor combined) defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Finished pillow defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Cover	Material not as specified.	X	
	Color not as specified.	X	
	Cover fabricated from more than two pieces of material.	X	
	Hole, cut or tear.	X	
	Spot, stain, or streak clearly noticeable when viewed at a distance of 3 feet.		X
	Stitch type not as specified.	X	
	Seam type not as specified.		X
	Any seam open more than 1 inch.	X	
	Any seam open more than 1/4 inch but less than 1 inch.		X
	Note: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when 2 or more continuous skipped stitches or run-offs occur.	X	
	Seam plated or badly twisted.	X	
	Loose tension resulting in a loose seam.		X
	Tight tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied to stitching.)		X
	Needle chew.	X	
	Cover loose or puckered to an extent adversely affecting appearance.		X
Cleanness	Untrimmed thread ends on exterior of pillow.		X
	Urethane pieces not removed throughout outside of pillow.		X
	Offensive or objectionable odor.	X	
Workmanship	Filling not evenly distributed throughout cover.		X
Identification label	Missing, incorrect, text incomplete, illegible or insecurely attached.		X

4.2.3.2 Size of shredded urethane pieces. Determination shall be made of the size of the shredded urethane pieces in the finished pillow. The pillow shall be opened and a handful of pieces selected from within at random. (Note: The pieces may be selected prior to final closure of the pillow cover.) Six pieces shall be measured by ruler. Any measurement not within the size range as specified in 3.1.2 shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit for this examination shall be one completely finished pillow. The sample size shall be as specified in table II. The lot size shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any specified requirement.

4.2.3.3 Total weight. Determination shall be made of the weight of the finished pillow. Any total weight deviating from the specified weight by more than the tolerance shall be considered a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one pillow. The sample unit for this examination shall be one completely finished pillow. The inspection level shall be level S-3 and the acceptable quality level shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE V. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pillow shall be placed in a close-fitting bag fabricated from film a minimum of 2 mils thick conforming to L-P-378, type 1, grade A, B, or C, finish. The heat seal of the seams and closure shall conform to the strength requirements of L-P-378. Excess air shall be evacuated to a practicable minimum prior to final seal of package. The information label attached to each pillow shall be positioned in a manner that will allow them to be easily read without opening the bag. Each bagged pillow shall be further packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, style FOL, end opening, grade W5c. The boxes shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Level B. Each pillow shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1 except that the box shall not be required.

5.1.3 Level C. Each pillow shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturers standard practice, providing that this insures protection for the pillow during shipment and provides for safe delivery to its destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), twelve pillows packaged as specified in 5.1.1 or 5.1.2 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Close, seal, and strap in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve pillows packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic grade 275 minimum. Closure shall be in accordance with Method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Pillows in quantities as specified (see 6.2), packaged as specified in 5.1.3 shall be packed in containers that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification or the National Motor Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Pillows covered by this specification are intended for general bedding use and are nonallergenic.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Whether cover should be other then white (see 3.5).
(c) When identification label is not required (see 3.6.2).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

GSA CC 76-7204

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.